Abbad Ali

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EDUCATION

Georgia State University Aug 2025-present
J. Mack Robinson College of Business | M.S. in Financial Mathematics

- GPA: 4.1/4.3. Fully funded merit award.
- Focus on quantitative risk analysis and management, with doctoral-level economics coursework.

Lahore University of Management Sciences Sep 2019-Jun 2023
B.S. in Economics and Mathematics, joint major

- Fully funded merit scholarship. Senior year project supervised by Dr. Syed Zahid Ali.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Economics of AI safety; decision-making under uncertainty; beliefs about catastrophic risk.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Georgia State University Aug 2025-present
With Professor Stephen H. Shore

Market-informed identification and regulation of AI risk Work in progress
Collaborator: Stephen H. Shore

- Contribute to research on how prices of feasible contracts can help identify risky AI activities and the firms engaged in them.
- The framework combines market prices with firm-activity information to estimate firm-specific probabilities of large, non-catastrophic losses under an explicit homogeneity assumption, informing remediation and financial penalties.

Beliefs and Values About Existential Risk Jun 2026-present
Collaborators: Stephen H. Shore, Ivy Diallo, and Kae Gruner

- Design and run an ongoing pre/post survey study of selection into existential-risk coursework and changes in beliefs, values, and risk perception.
- Develop survey instruments and an identification strategy using treatment and comparison groups.
- Collect responses and analyze them using regression and sensitivity analysis; study design, data collection, and analysis are ongoing.

Research assistance: Managing Existential Risk from AI: Investing in Delay, Learning, and Alignment Jan-Jun 2026
For Stephen H. Shore and Richard Peter

- Conducted a systematic literature review across decision theory, existential risk, and AI governance to support the paper's theoretical framework.

SELECTED ACADEMIC PROJECTS

When Paper Fades: How Digital States Redraw the Map of Corruption Dec 2025

Graduate econometrics course project | With Nourhan Hajjaj and Reza Nosarti

- Examined digital government and perceived corruption in a panel of 133 countries from 2012 to 2022, comprising 1,463 country-year observations.
- Estimated models with country and year fixed effects, regime-type interactions, and standard errors clustered by country.
- Assessed limits arising from reverse causality, perception-based measures, and interpolation of the biennial digital-government index; treated the estimates as observational associations.

Computational Economics and Analysis Sep 2022-May 2023

Senior year project, LUMS | Supervisor: Dr. Syed Zahid Ali

- Authored *Dynare-Based Assessment of DSGE Models and their Social Welfare Implications: A Macro Analysis Handbook*, an undergraduate guide to computational macroeconomics and social welfare analysis.
- Explained how to use Dynare to study dynamic stochastic general equilibrium models and their social welfare implications.

Handbook on SSRN

Healthcare access in Baltistan Jul-Aug 2022

Summer Research Program, University of Baltistan

- Conducted field research on barriers to healthcare access in the Baltistan region of Pakistan and analyzed data using R and Excel.

TEACHING AND COURSE DEVELOPMENT

Teaching Assistant, Georgia State University Aug 2025-present

Scientific Perspective on Existential Risk

Teaching Assistant, Lahore University of Management Sciences Aug 2021-May 2023

Precalculus, calculus, and probability

Online course development: Quantification of Existential Risk

Course led by Professor Stephen H. Shore

- Helped develop the online version and contributed to selected modules, primarily artificial intelligence and humanity's future.
- Subsequently prepared the free public edition.

Public course | Contributor credit

APPLIED POLICY AND ANALYTICAL EXPERIENCE

Strategy Consultant - Delivery Unit Sep 2023-Sep 2025
The Palladium Group, Pakistan

- Led delivery work on provincial initiatives across health, social welfare, and urban development in Punjab.
- Co-developed a five-year healthcare roadmap using cost-effectiveness analysis and simulation modeling.
- Built performance dashboards to monitor public-hospital services and high-priority reforms, and authored policy briefs and analytical reports for government decision-makers.
- Analyzed health-insurance costs and financing options to support the fiscal sustainability of the Sehat Sahulat program.

HONORS AND FELLOWSHIPS

- Government Analytics Fellow, The World Bank.
- Ethics Ambassador, United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime.
- Science Talent Farming Scheme Scholar, Pakistan Science Foundation.

SELECTED TRAINING

- Reproducible Research Methods, Institute of Economic Development, The World Bank.
- AGI Strategy, BlueDot Impact - enrolled.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming and data: Python, R, Stata, MATLAB, Dynare, SQL.

Methods: Econometric panel analysis, survey design, scenario and sensitivity analysis, cost-effectiveness analysis, computational macroeconomics.

Research tools: LaTeX, Git.

SELECTED SERVICE

Flygrad - study-abroad guidance

- Built an application for study-abroad guidance after more than 5,000 students applied to an initial offer to help five.

flygradai.tech